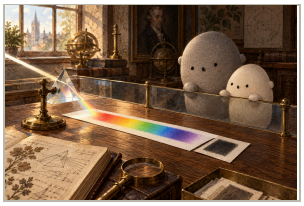
A little strip of light

The light we cannot see. · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____



A simplified reconstruction of Ritter's discovery, not a home experiment. The dark sample is a clue to unseen UV.

A SIMPLIFIED STRIP · POSITIONS ONLY

Light	UV-A	Violet	Blue	Green	Yellow	Orange	Red
Place	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

UV-A is unseen. The other six names are visible colors. Real colors blend; these boxes are not equal measured bands.

1. There are 7 places. One is unseen UV-A. How many places name visible colors?

7 − 1 = _____ Show your thinking.

2. Start at place 1, UV-A. How many one-place hops reach place 7, red?

7 − 1 = _____ Show your thinking.

3. Green is at place 4. Red is at place 7. How many places farther along is red?

7 − 4 = _____ Show your thinking.

Wavelength is the space from one wave crest to the next. Imagine how stretched out a drawn wave looks. Along our strip toward red, wavelengths get longer. Which end would have more closely spaced crests?